



COLOR TELEVISION

The American television broadcaster CBS showed the first color TV program on June 25, 1951. Unfortunately, few viewers saw the benefit, as most people had black-and-white televisions then. Britain produced its first color TV in 1967, but it was not until the 1970s that more color TV sets were bought than black-and-white ones.

Sony Trinitron, a popular color TV of the 1970s

DIGITAL TELEVISION

The biggest evolution since color has been the possibility to receive television signals in a digital format rather than analog.

Beginning in the 2000s, this allowed TV companies to broadcast better quality sound, a higher definition picture, and a wider range of channels than they ever could before.



BT Vision TV digital cable box

Professional digital HD camera



HD TELEVISION

HD (high definition) is a television display technology that provides picture quality similar to a movie theater experience—pictures have more detail and are much sharper and more colorful. The first HD TV broadcast was of the Statue of Liberty and New York Harbor, shown in Japan in 1989, but HD broadcasts only became common in the 2000s.

Server racks in a data center in Germany



STREAMING

In recent years, TV has changed enormously. Thanks to the Internet and the ability to watch shows live, we can now view whatever we want, wherever we want. We don't even need a television—we can use our phones or laptops—and we are not dependent on broadcasters, just a fast link to a computer server.